

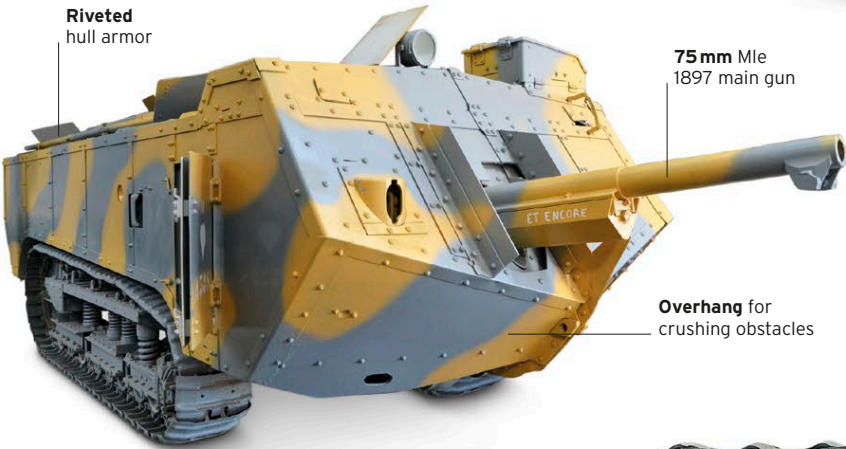
Tanks of World War I

Tanks were first used on September 15, 1916. Between then and the Armistice of November 11, 1918, Britain, France, and Germany all developed tanks. Britain's heavy tanks, which had tracks around their entire bodies, were adapted for crossing trenches in support of infantry, and the faster Medium Whippet was developed to support cavalry in more open country. As well as a small number of heavier vehicles, the French used masses of light FT tanks in 1918. Germany built only a small number of A7Vs, relying more on captured British Mark IVs instead.

▷ **Schneider CA-1**

Date	1917	Country	France
Weight	14.9 tons (13.5 tonnes)		
Engine	Schneider 4-cylinder gasoline, 60hp		
Main armament	75 mm Schneider Blockhaus gun		

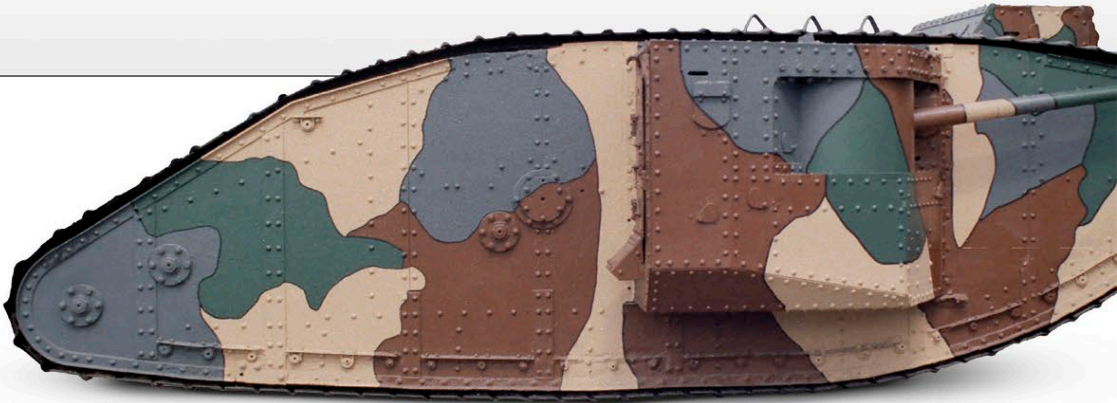
The first French tank to see service, the six-man Schneider was based on the Holt tractor. Its 75 mm gun was offset to the right, limiting its field of fire. Four hundred were built, but took heavy losses when they first saw action on April 14, 1917. They struggled to cross trenches, but fared better in the advances of 1918.



▽ **Mark IV**

Date	1917	Country	UK
Weight	31.4 tons (28.4 tonnes)		
Engine	Daimler gasoline, 105hp		
Main armament	2 x QF 6-pounder 6 cwt Hotchkiss L/23 guns		

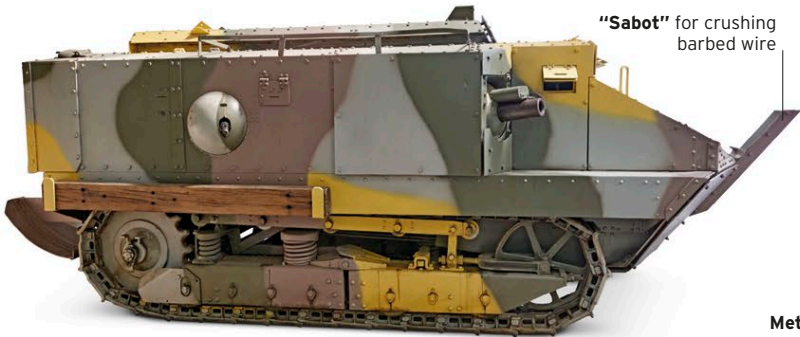
The Mark IV was an improvement on Britain's earlier tanks. It was better armored and its guns and sponsons were modified to improve mobility. Also, its gasoline tanks were larger, armored, and were vacuum- rather than gravity-fed. Over 1,200 were built, seeing action from June 1917 until the end of the war.



△ **Mark I**

Date	1916	Country	UK
Weight	31.4 tons (28.4 tonnes)		
Engine	Daimler gasoline, 105hp		
Main armament	2 x QF 6-pounder Hotchkiss L/40 guns		

The Mark I was made of armor plate up to 0.5in (12 mm) thick. Of the 150 built, half were Male (shown here) and half Female—the latter replacing each of the Male's 6-pounder guns with two .303 Vickers machine guns. The tank had a crew of eight, including four for driving and steering.



< **St. Chamond**

Date	1917	Country	France
Weight	25.3 tons (23 tonnes)		
Engine	Panhard Levassor 4-cylinder gasoline, 90hp		
Main armament	75 mm Mle 1897 gun		

The eight-man St. Chamond first saw combat in May 1917. Like the Schneider, it was based on the Holt tractor and had an overhang to crush obstacles—but this also made it prone to getting stuck in trenches. Four hundred were built, and proved useful as assault guns in the open warfare of 1918.

